

The Noble Great Lord of the Earth

Āryamahāmahendranāmadhāraṇī · Toh 523 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་སའ་དྲིབ་པ་ཚེ་པ་ལྷོ་བྱུང་གི་ཟུངས།

Toh 523 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Āryamahāmahāindra-nāma-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as "The Noble Great Lord of the Earth" (འཕགས་པ་སའ་དྲིབ་པ་ཚེ་པ་ལྷོ་བྱུང་གི་ཟུངས།). It belongs to the dhāraṇī class of canonical literature, presenting a sacred incantation framed within a discourse involving the buddha Sarvaprabha and a brahmin figure called Great Lord of the Earth. The text is concerned with the purification of all beings, as reflected in the closing colophon of the preceding work, which describes the dhāraṇī's power to completely purify all sentient beings. It sits within the Kangyur's collection of dhāraṇī scriptures, a broad grouping of texts that preserve mantric and ritual formulas regarded as the speech of enlightened beings.

The dhāraṇī called Paye Shéyé Tala La, which completely purifies all beings, is complete.

In the language of India: Āryamahāmahāndranāma-dhāraṇī. In the Tibetan language: The dhāraṇī called The Noble Great Lord of the Earth.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Sarvaprabha, was dwelling in a place graced with gods, in the company of the brahmin Great Lord of the Earth who was like a great sāla tree. Then the brahmin Great Lord of the Earth, who was like a great sāla tree, went to where the Blessed One, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Sarvaprabha, was, and having arrived, he prostrated with his head at the feet of the Blessed One, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Sarvaprabha, and took his seat to one side. Seated to one side, the brahmin Great Lord of the Earth, who was like a great sāla tree, addressed the Blessed One, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Sarvaprabha, with these words:

Blessed One, I have made an aspiration toward unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. By what means shall I be able to recall my past lives? Please, Blessed One, explain to me clearly the method by which I will not forget the mind of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

When this had been said, the Blessed One, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Sarvaprabha, spoke to the brahmin Great Lord of the Earth who was like a great sāla tree in these words:

Therefore, son, if you have made such an aspiration, take up this heart-essence of the vidyā mantra of Sarvaprabha. Memorize it. Retain it. Make it fully complete within you. What then is the heart-essence of the vidyā mantra of Sarvaprabha? It is this:

tadyathā — āmodanī, pramodanī, vimodanī, saṃmodanī, priyaṃkaraṇī,
śrīkaraṇī, śrākaraṇī, bodhikaraṇī, anuttarasamyaksambuddhakaraṇī,
anuttarāryakaraṇī, anuttaraprajñākaraṇī, anuttaravarśīkaraṇī,
anuttarasarvakleśopakleśavidharaṇī, abadyānadhakara-vidhamani,
anuttaravidyā-ālokoṭpādanī, anuttaraśaikṣaśīlaviṃyācaraṇa,
vimuktiguṇagaṇa, saṃbādhani, anuttarasarvakuśalamūloddhani,
anuttarabhona-mūlanī, anuttararāgadveṣamoha-namūlanī,
anuttareśaikṣamana-avidyā, andhakāra-vidhamani, anuttarāsī-apratihatacakra,
anuttārasarvalāravavidhrāmaṇī, tvam hi bhadre, anuttāra-va-bhadra,
subhadra, śrībhadra, anuttarabhadra, samantabhadra, asamasama-bhadra,
anuttara-mahāpuruṣabhadra, anuttara-mahāpuruṣasevitā,
anuttara-mahāpuruṣānuvartanī, anuttare-mahāpuruṣadharma-deśikā,
anuttara-mahāpuruṣadharmakośa-saṃvādhikā, anuttara-mahāpuruṣa-nirvāṇa,
anutapratarśakā, tvam hi bhadre, gaṅgāsita-pakṣu, samyaksambuddhe,
āsevitā, bhāvitā, bahulīkrodha, stuta, staupita-varṇitā, praśasta.

Son, this is the heart-essence of the vidyā mantra of Sarvaprabha. Therefore, son, you should keep this heart-essence of the vidyā mantra of Sarvaprabha in mind whether you are walking, standing, sitting, or lying down.

Son, whoever bears in mind this heart-essence of the vidyā mantra of Sarvaprabha by name, by lineage, or by the specific category of their lineage — whether man or woman, boy or girl, god or goddess, nāga or nāginī, gandharva or gandharvī, asura or asurinī, or any human being whatsoever —

or kumbhāṇḍa or kumbhāṇḍinī, hungry ghost or female hungry ghost, flesh-eater or female flesh-eater, kumbhāṇḍa or kumbhāṇḍinī, skeleton or female skeleton — whoever bears in mind, reads, recites, teaches, or holds this heart-essence of the vidyā mantra of Sarvaprabha, from that time forward they will remember their past lives for seven successive lifetimes. And for as long as they continue to transmigrate in saṃsāra, they will not forget the mind of unsurpassable and perfectly complete awakening. Whether they are reborn

as a god or as a human, they will not meet an untimely death by weapons, poison, water, or fire. Homage to the Blessed One, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Sarvavijaya Kāśyapagotra and his lineage. Homage to the Blessed One, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Amitābha, Victor, Kāśyapagotra and his lineage. Homage to the Blessed One, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Immortal Great Light, Victor, Kāśyapagotra and his lineage. Homage to the Blessed One, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Great Light, Victor, Kāśyapagotra and his lineage. Homage to the Blessed One, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Great Radiance, Victor, Kāśyapagotra and his lineage. Homage to the Blessed One, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Light Without Equal, Victor, Kāśyapagotra and his lineage. Homage to the Blessed One, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Light Equal to the Unequalled, Victor, Kāśyapagotra and his lineage. Homage to all seven of those Blessed Ones, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas, Great Sages, Kāśyapagotra and their lineages. Homage to those who have entered the sphere of peace, together with their retinues. Homage, homage.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the great brahmin Mahāpṛthivīpati, like a great śāla tree, was filled with joy and praised what the Blessed One had said. The noble

Translator's Notes

- The text opens with a colophon closing a preceding dhāraṇī text ("Paye Shéyé Tala La ... is complete"), and then immediately opens the new text, the Āryamahāmahāndra-nāmadhāraṇī. The Sanskrit title reconstructs as Āryamahāmahendranāmadhāraṇī, meaning "The Noble Dhāraṇī called the Great Great Indra of the Earth," which the Tibetan renders as "The Noble Great Lord of the Earth." The buddha name "Sarvaprabha" (Tibetan: Kun tu 'od, "Universal Radiance / Omniluminous") is rendered in translation rather than transliterated, as it is a descriptive epithet-name not a standard canonical proper name requiring retention. The mantra syllables are transcribed as closely as the Tibetan phonetic rendering allows; some Sanskrit forms are uncertain due to the limitations of Tibetan phonetic transcription of Sanskrit, and the mantra text breaks off mid-sentence in the source passage as given.
 - The Tibetan term ཀུམ་བླ་མ་ (rendered here as kumbhāṇḍa) appears twice, once in masculine and once in feminine form, and the same is true for རྩུང་མ་ (skeleton or revenant). The preceding passage already established the pattern of paired male-female supernatural beings, and these follow that same pattern. The Tibetan name བཀྲ་ཤིས་ལག་པོ་ (Kāśyapa) here appears to designate a lineage or gotra affiliation, not a personal name, so "Kāśyapagotra" renders the sense accurately. The passage breaks off mid-sentence with རྩུང་མ་, indicating the text continues beyond the supplied excerpt.
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Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.